The Chattanooga Guides Series

Restaurants with a View in Chattanooga, TN - 17 Locations

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Geo coverage: Chattanooga, TN and surrounding area (North Shore, Suck Creek, Lookout Mountain, Jasper TN, Guild TN, Rising Fawn GA)

#restaurants #interactive

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This guide covers *16* restaurants, cafes, and bars in Chattanooga where the view is part of the draw. The listings span Tennessee River waterfront, downtown rooftop bars, Lookout Mountain overlooks, and elevated spots a short drive out.

Chattanooga's geography creates several distinct settings. The Tennessee River runs through the city center and narrows into a gorge to the west. Lookout Mountain rises 2,300 feet just south of downtown. Several spots sit directly at water level; others look out over the valley from elevation.

The downtown entries are within walking distance of each other. Whitebird and Tony's Pasta are both on Bluff View. Scottie's is on Riverfront Pkwy. Whiskey Thief at The Edwin is a rooftop bar with river views a few blocks north. The Dwell's Matilda Midnight is a few blocks south.

Four entries are a 20 to 30 minute drive from downtown. Top of the Rock is in Jasper. Riverdance at River Gorge Ranch is in Guild. Canyon Grill and Auld Alliance at McLemore Resort are on the Georgia side of Lookout Mountain. These work as a destination, not an add-on to a downtown day.

The filters are worth using. *Water* narrows to river and lake views at table level. *Mountain* covers elevated valley views. Top of the Rock and Riverdance both have on-site breweries. See the breweries and wineries guide for taproom-only options.

If there is a spot worth adding, send an email. Hours and seasonal programming change. Confirm before making a special trip.

Map View Of The Restaurant Locations Below

View:

← Try Me

Water | Rooftop | Mountain

When:

Brunch | Lunch | Dinner | Drinks | Outdoor seating | Book ahead

Neighborhood:

Downtown | North Shore | Lookout Mountain | Suck Creek

Jasper (~30 min) Guild (~20 min) Rising Fawn (~20 min)

1. The Boathouse Rotisserie & Raw Bar .

Riverside Dr, right on the Tennessee River. Tables inside and on the deck both face the water. Seafood focused menu built around the raw bar and rotisserie. Book ahead for weekend dinners.

Google Maps Website

#water #north-shore #dinner #lunch #outdoor-seating #reservations-recommended

2. Whitebird at The Edwin Hotel .

Ground floor of The Edwin Hotel facing the Walnut Street Bridge and the Tennessee River. Modern Appalachian cuisine from the Tennessee River Valley, named for Chief John Ross, whose Cherokee name translates to "Mysterious Little Whitebird." Dinner Tuesday through Sunday, brunch Saturday and Sunday. Upstairs is Whiskey Thief, a rooftop bar with over 100 Tennessee whiskeys and open-air river views.

Google Maps Website

#water #rooftop #downtown #brunch #dinner #drinks

3. The Dwell Hotel .

The Dwell has Matilda Midnight, an open-air cocktail bar on the property at E 10th St. Cocktails are the draw, city skyline as the backdrop. Seating is weather dependent, so check availability before it becomes the plan.

Google Maps Website

#rooftop #downtown #drinks

4. Stone Cup Cafe .

North Shore spot with an upstairs lounge and a river facing patio on Frazier Ave. More coffee stop than restaurant, but the patio has a solid Tennessee River view. Also in the coffeeshops guide. Good warm weather stop before or after the Riverwalk.

Google Maps Coffee Shops Guide

#water #north-shore #drinks #outdoor-seating

5. Canopy Coffee and Wine Bar .

Patio on Lookout Mountain that shifts from coffee to wine and beer as the day winds down. Views out over the valley. Good stop after the Incline Railway, Reflection Riding, or a Cumberland Trail segment. Also in the coffeeshops guide.

Google Maps Coffee Shops Guide

#mountain #lookout-mountain #drinks #outdoor-seating

6. River Drifters .

Suck Creek Road patio with dog friendly seating and creek views out to the Tennessee River. Menu runs smashburgers, sandwiches, fresh seafood (blackened catfish, crab cakes, fried shrimp), and a bison burger. Friday all-you-can-eat catfish is a recurring special. Craft beer focus, active local tap list. They rent kayaks and SUPs on site. Gets packed on weekends.

Google Maps Website Facebook

#water #suck-creek #lunch #dinner #drinks #outdoor-seating

7. Scottie's On The River .

Riverfront Pkwy with direct Tennessee River views and sightlines to the John Ross Bridge. Menu goes heavy on seafood: oysters on the half shell, blue crab cakes, fried lobster tail, stuffed shrimp, pan-seared trout. Steaks and chops for the non-seafood table. Sunday brunch 11am to 3pm. Cocktail program, live music on select nights. Walk-in only.

Google Maps Website

#water #downtown #brunch #lunch #dinner

8. Top of the Rock Restaurant & Brewery .

About 30 minutes from downtown in Jasper Highlands, on top of Jasper Mountain with views of the Tennessee River valley. 3,000 sq ft of deck space and floor-to-ceiling windows inside. Named one of the 50 most beautiful restaurants in the US by People and OpenTable in 2024. On-site brewery: kolsch, IPA, wheat, red ale, rotating seasonals. Southern menu: prime rib egg rolls, Chili Peach Shrimp, pizzas, steaks. Weekend brunch, live music Thursdays, heated outdoor igloos in season. Reservations via OpenTable.

Google Maps Website

#mountain #water #jasper #brunch #lunch #dinner #drinks #outdoor-seating #reservations-recommended

9. Riverdance Restaurant at River Gorge Ranch .

About 25 minutes from downtown in Guild, TN, above the Tennessee River Gorge with views of the river and Lake Nickajack. Opened February 2026. The 13,000 sq ft building has floor-to-ceiling windows facing the gorge and an on-site brewery. Modern Southern cuisine, craft cocktails, house-brewed beer. Open daily, with weekend brunch Saturday and Sunday 9:30am to 2:30pm. Reservations via OpenTable.

Google Maps Website

#mountain #water #guild #brunch #lunch #dinner

#drinks

10. Canyon Grill .

Georgia side of Lookout Mountain's ridgeline in Rising Fawn, about 20 minutes from downtown. Views span four states from the top. Dinner only, Tuesday through Saturday. Southern American gastropub menu: catfish, rack of lamb, duck, pork tenderloin, chicken piccata. BYOB, beer and wine only. Reservations recommended, walk-ins accommodated.

Google Maps Website

#mountain #rising-fawn #dinner #reservations-recommended

11. Auld Alliance at McLemore Resort .

About 30 minutes from downtown at McLemore Resort (Curio Collection by Hilton) in Rising Fawn, GA. The restaurant sits at the cliff edge of Lookout Mountain, looking out over McLemore Cove, a bowl-shaped valley that drops sharply off the ridge. Scottish and French fine dining built on highland fare from both traditions. Non-hotel guests welcome. The property also has Croft for casual all-day dining and Skyside, a poolside outdoor bar with views. Reservations required and they book out fast.

Google Maps Website

#mountain #rising-fawn #dinner #reservations-recommended

12. Tony's Pasta Shop & Trattoria .

In the former carriage house of the T.C. Thompson mansion on Bluff View, 212 High St. The upper patio deck faces the Tennessee River directly. Homemade pasta and fresh bread made daily. Named Best Italian Restaurant by the Chattanooga Times Free Press two years running. Reservations recommended.

Google Maps Website

#water #downtown #dinner #lunch #reservations-recommended

13. Lakeshore Grille .

Above Lakeshore Marina on Chickamauga Lake at 5600 Lake Resort Terrace. Covered patio faces the water. Menu runs fresh seafood, hand cut steaks, and burgers. Dinner Tuesday through Saturday, brunch Sunday 11am to 4pm. Closed Monday.

Google Maps Website

#water #dinner #brunch #outdoor-seating

14. Stratus Rooftop .

Rooftop bar on top of Caption by Hyatt at 105 W Main St on the Southside. Craft cocktails, shareable plates, and city skyline views from above the ridge. Wednesday through Friday from

5pm, Saturday and Sunday from 2pm. Walk-in only, no reservations for regular service.

Google Maps Website

#rooftop #downtown #drinks

15. Iris Rooftop at The Waymark .

On the 11th floor of The Waymark Hotel at 736 Broad St. Iris is the highest rooftop bar downtown. Sharing plates, craft cocktails, and fire pits, with skyline views toward Lookout Mountain. Open to the public, not just hotel guests. Evenings from 4pm on weekdays and 2pm on weekends, weekend brunch 10am to 2pm, bar until midnight.

Google Maps Website

#rooftop #downtown #brunch #drinks

16. Rembrandt's Coffee House .

European-style cafe in the Bluff View Art District at 204 High St, a short walk from Tony's Pasta. The outdoor terrace, strung with jasmine and lights, looks over the Tennessee River and the Walnut Street Bridge. House-roasted coffee, hand-made pastries, and casual savory fare. Open daily 8am to 9pm. More a coffee-and-view stop than a full meal.

Google Maps Website

#water #downtown #drinks #outdoor-seating

17. Pickle Barrel .

Downtown institution in the historic flatiron building at 1012 Market St. The covered roof deck up top is an under-the-radar spot for skyline and ridgeline views, with Lookout Mountain in the distance on clear days. Fried pickles, pub food, and rotating craft beer. Casual, affordable, and open late to 3am.

Google Maps

#rooftop #downtown #lunch #dinner #drinks #outdoor-seating

Reserve the out-of-city spots for evenings or full days when you can make the drive part of the plan. Top of the Rock has live music on Thursdays. Canyon Grill serves dinner only, Tuesday through Saturday. Auld Alliance books out fast, so plan ahead.

Weekday evenings and Sunday brunch tend to work better for downtown spots. Scottie's is walk-in only, so arrive early on weekends. Tony's Pasta and Whitebird both take reservations and fill up on Saturday nights.

River Drifters on Suck Creek has dog-friendly outdoor seating and rents kayaks on site. Stone Cup's North Shore patio is a good warm-weather stop before or after the Riverwalk.

This guide is updated as new spots open. If a listing has changed or a view-worthy spot is missing, send a note.

FAQ.

Where are the best waterfront restaurants in Chattanooga?

The Boathouse on Riverside Dr (North Shore), Scottie's On The River on Riverfront Pkwy, and Tony's Pasta on Bluff View are the most full-service waterfront dinner options. Stone Cup Cafe on Frazier Ave is primarily a coffee stop with a river-facing patio. River Drifters on Suck Creek Road is a patio bar with creek views and a food menu.

Are there rooftop bars in Chattanooga with views?

Whiskey Thief at The Edwin Hotel has Tennessee River views and over 100 Tennessee whiskeys on the menu. Matilda Midnight at The Dwell Hotel is a smaller open-air cocktail bar with city skyline views. Both are weather dependent, so confirm before making either one the main plan.

Do I need reservations at these restaurants?

Auld Alliance at McLemore Resort requires reservations and books out fast. Top of the Rock takes reservations via OpenTable. Tony's Pasta and Canyon Grill both recommend reservations. Scottie's On The River is walk-in only.

What restaurants or bars have views on Lookout Mountain?

Canopy Coffee and Wine Bar is the most accessible, open from coffee hours into wine and beer. Canyon Grill is dinner only, Tuesday through Saturday, with four-state views from the Georgia ridgeline. Auld Alliance at McLemore Resort is fine dining at the cliff edge, reservations required.

Where can I have brunch with a view in Chattanooga?

Scottie's On The River runs Sunday brunch from 11am to 3pm, walk-in only. Top of the Rock offers weekend brunch at its Jasper Mountain location. Riverdance at River Gorge Ranch in Guild also has brunch. Lakeshore Grille runs Sunday brunch from 11am to 4pm above Chickamauga Lake.

Which restaurants near downtown have outdoor seating with water views?

Boathouse on Riverside Dr has a riverfront deck right on the Tennessee River. Stone Cup Cafe has a river-facing patio on Frazier Ave on the North Shore. Scottie's On The River has riverfront seating on Riverfront Pkwy. River Drifters on Suck Creek has creek-to-river patio seating about 10 minutes west of downtown.

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